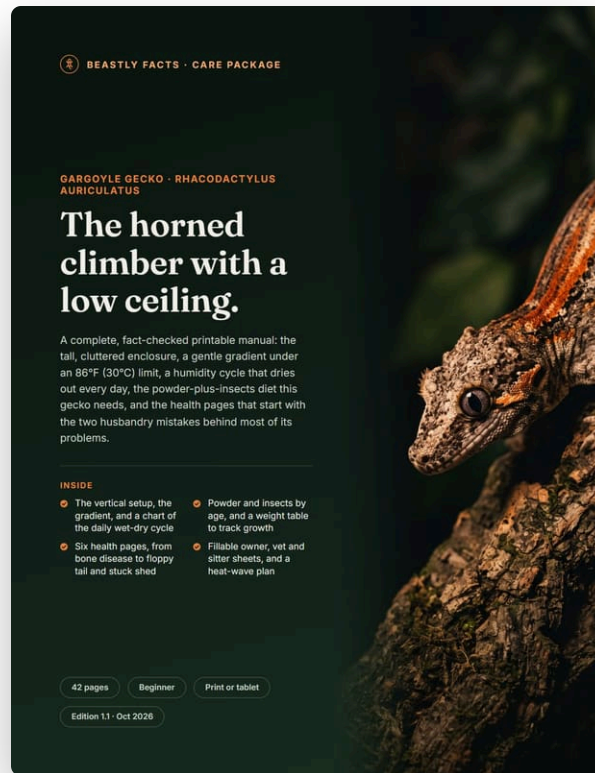


FREE SAMPLE

Gargoyle Gecko Care Package

The first 4 pages of the 42-page printable manual, free to keep.



In this sample: What's inside, How to Use This Package, Quick Profile & Cost Overview. The contents page shows every one of the 42 pages, so you can see exactly what the full package covers before you buy it.

Not in this sample: the 38 pages that follow, which are the full care guide, the health section, the quick reference cards, and the owner tools, checklists and logs.

The full package is \$8.99 at beastlyfacts.com/care-packages/gargoyle-gecko/. One purchase, and every corrected edition is a free re-download from your library. The free gargoyle gecko care guide it was built from is at beastlyfacts.com/guides/gargoyle-gecko/, and stays free.

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Every page is written to be used, not just read once.

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START HERE

How to use this package

Three ways to get value from it, depending on where you are right now.

If you haven't bought a gecko yet

Read pages 4 through 10 in order before buying anything, then the feeding section. Two decisions are the expensive ones to get wrong. The first is the enclosure on page 5: it has to be tall, and it has to be packed with branches, because this gecko grips branches better than glass and sleeping on bare glass is what bends its tail. The second is the heat on page 6: a gentle warm spot, and a room that never pushes the air past 86°F (30°C). Settle both, then use the Budget and Shopping List on page 30 to buy once instead of twice.

If your gecko is already home

Start with the Setup Checklist on page 28 to audit what you have. Then read the humidity cycle on page 7: an enclosure that never dries out causes respiratory infection, and one that stays too dry causes the stuck shed that costs this species its toes. Then weigh the gecko and start the log on page 37, because a falling weight is usually the first sign of trouble. If anything already looks wrong, go straight to Health Red Flags on page 22.

Print these first

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Page 28: Setup Checklist & Targets | ☐ Page 36: Pet-Sitter Sheet |
| ☐ Page 29: Emergency & Quick Targets Card | ☐ Page 37: Owner Log |
| ☐ Page 33: Symptom Quick Reference | ☐ Page 38: Equipment & Vet Log |
| ☐ Page 34: Daily, Weekly & Seasonal Routine | ☐ Page 15: Weight, Growth & Body Condition |

WHY THIS PACKAGE EXISTS

The gargoyle gecko is usually sold as "a crested gecko with horns", and the two do share an island, a powdered diet and a tall enclosure. The differences are what catch new keepers out. This gecko needs live insects as a real part of its diet, not a treat. It grips branches better than glass. Its tail grows back, and its bite can break skin. And the most repeated advice about it, that it needs no heat at all, is wrong: it needs a gentle warm spot, with a ceiling it must never pass. Every figure here is cross-checked against the veterinary and species sources listed on page 41, and every temperature and dimension is given in both imperial and metric.

UNITS USED THROUGHOUT

Every temperature and size is given twice. Temperatures appear in degrees Fahrenheit (°F) with degrees Celsius (°C) beside them. Sizes appear in inches (in) with centimeters (cm) beside them. Weights are in grams (g), the unit a kitchen scale shows, with ounces (oz) for the powder bag. Humidity is a percentage (%) of the moisture the air could hold. Prices are in United States dollars.

NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR

A veterinarian who treats reptiles. This is a husbandry reference for day-to-day care, and anything urgent is a professional call, not a page in this book. Not every practice sees reptiles, so find one before you need one, and write the number on page 29.

Quick profile

Everything at a glance before you read the detail.

Scientific name	<i>Rhacodactylus auriculatus</i> , described in 1869. Named for the bony, horn-like bumps on its head, which resemble a stone gargoyle's
Native range	Southern New Caledonia, a group of islands between Australia and Fiji, the same islands as the crested gecko. Humid forest and scrub, on shrubs and saplings, mostly within a few meters of the ground
Adult size	7 to 9 in (18 to 23 cm) including the tail. About 45 to 65 g as an adult, depending on sex and genetics
Captive lifespan	15 to 20 years typical, with some keepers reporting animals still breeding past 20. Wild lifespan has not been studied
Activity	Arboreal, meaning it lives off the ground, climbing. Sleepier by day and active after dark
Diet	Omnivore. A complete powdered diet as the base, plus live insects, which this species needs. Page 11
Enclosure, one adult	18×18×24 in (46×46×61 cm) minimum, the 24 in being height; 24×24×24 in (61×61×61 cm) ideal. One gecko per enclosure
Temperature	Cool end 70 to 75°F (21 to 24°C), basking spot 82 to 85°F (28 to 29°C). Air never above 86°F (30°C), never below 65°F (18°C)
Humidity	50 to 70%: a heavy evening mist, then a dry-back toward 50% before the next one. Page 7
UVB	UVB (ultraviolet B) is the band of ultraviolet light that lets a gecko make its own vitamin D3, the vitamin it needs to use calcium. Optional for this species and worth having: a low-output tube, 12 hours a day. Page 8
Handling	Adults calm and slow; juveniles jumpy. The tail drops if grabbed and grows back. A bite is rare and can break skin
Conservation status	Least Concern on the IUCN Red List, the global list of species at risk kept by the International Union for Conservation of Nature. New Caledonia stopped issuing export permits, so pet geckos descend from founders exported decades ago. Every one for sale should be captive-bred

Cost overview

Initial setup

The gecko is \$50 to \$300 for a common reticulated (net-patterned) or striped animal, \$500 to \$1,000 or more for a premium color line. Itemized with the heat lamp, thermostat, first food and supplements, the setup comes to **\$335 to \$630**. With a first vet exam and a common gecko, plan on **\$435 to \$1,080**. Page 30 has every line.

Ongoing

Diet, insects, supplements, two UVB tubes, electricity and a yearly checkup run **\$320 to \$565 a year**. Food and supplements run about \$15 to \$30 a month. An illness visit with tests runs \$150 to \$600.

THE NUMBER THAT SHOULD DRIVE THE DECISION

Not the price. The lifespan. A gecko bought for a ten-year-old is very likely still alive when that child is in their late twenties. At \$320 to \$565 a year for 15 to 20 years, the routine care alone comes to roughly \$4,800 to \$11,300, before a single emergency.